



Tableau Ecosystem Transcript

Welcome to BITS PLANET DIGITAL. Today we will continue our learning journey for the course Data Visualisation Storytelling. In this module, we will be now exploring the Tableau software, which is used for creating interesting and interactive visualisations, building advanced dashboards and finally creating data stories.

It is a very popular software used by the business analysts around the world for creating interactive dashboards and also publicly discussing data and stories with their audience. We will spend the next two modules learning the different features of Tableau and trying to build dashboards or creating a data story out of it. So now let us explore the basic features of Tableau, how to set up the software and then however see how you can connect some basic data and try to plot a chart.

Once you are familiarised with the environment, we will get into more details in later lessons. So what is Tableau? Tableau is a visual analytics platform that empowers organisations to understand and utilise data for problem solving. It is essentially a business intelligence tool which helps audience to create insights on the data presented by the analysts.

So why Tableau? Tableau is a very flexible and has a lot of optimised data connectors to the different types of data files that are there in the market. It can be connected to Excel text file and also to the cloud-based platforms like Microsoft SQL Server or Oracle Server and this gives you the veracity to work with various data types within the same environment. Similarly, Tableau's power comes from its intuitive platform which is very easy to use and creates most flexibility for the analyst to design visualisations.

According to Gartner, Tableau is the gold standard for intuitive and interactive visual analysis. And finally, Tableau dashboards are very easy for launching in production. So here I would like to take a small pause and explain that while we are developing the insights and knowledge about Tableau, we will not generally be discussing about how to set up this in the production environment.

This you can learn in the later parts of the course where in your particular work environment, you want to move this to the production where the real-time data and decisions are made on this. But we will be now only looking at the basic features of Tableau so that you are familiarised with the environment and later on connect it into the production environment. However, when you want to connect to a production environment, Tableau dashboards are very easy to be launched in production.

And Salesforce company owns Tableau and it is provided with a various range of options that we will see in a while. You have the free version which is Tableau public and you have the paid version and advanced version with desktop and Tableau server



where there are high-end features which are available on a subscription basis for the developers. So it is an entire range of product features.

But for the purposes of this course, we will be using the free version where you can learn the basics and learn the techniques of how to build visualisations in Tableau and take it from there. One of the main features is like Tableau allows customers or the users to spend more time on data and analytics and less time on data wrangling which refers to cleaning, arranging, sorting the data. So the machine works in an intuitive way to capture the different types of data, what are the structures and cleaning and also you spend more time on analysis and analytics that you want to convert the visualisations from the underlying data.

So like in always, the contents that we discuss in this course are very limited. So they are limited in the scope but you are encouraged to explore the wide range of resources that are available on the internet and also dedicated pages from the Tableau website itself which we will see in couple of minutes. So I advise you to please take time to explore the free resources that are there on the internet and enhance your learning journey.

So on YouTube, there are several how-to-do videos about Tableau which will help you build a very good understanding of the Tableau environment.

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